



Lego making Tron lightcycle

A fan-inspired idea for a LEGO light cycle from TRON: Legacy is actually happening.
<http://digit.in/LEGOTron>



Hasbro Cinematic Universe

Paramount Studios to release Hasbro themed movies in coming years, starting with G.I.Joe in 2020
<http://digit.in/HasbroCU>

The Talk of the Town

Chatbots are taking over as the new preferred interface for the end user, and here's how you can join the conversation

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hat bots? Those dumb automated things on messenger? Seriously? Yes. While chatbots may not be in the same

league as apps, they can do a lot more today than the ones you probably tried out for fun when they first emerged. From ordering you a pizza to counseling you for depression, bots have long surpassed the stage where you could dismiss them as just a fad. To give you an idea, the global chatbot market is expected to reach \$1.25 billion by 2025, growing at a CAGR of 24.3%, according to a new report by Grand View Research, Inc. And why wouldn't it? There are quite a few factors that have pushed them to popularity:

- **Dominance of messaging apps:** Chatbots reside within most of the apps you already use – Facebook messenger being a notable name. And if you look at numbers, usage of messaging apps has surpassed usage of social media this year.
- **App fatigue:** Numerous studies have indicated that people actually

use quite few apps, despite phone storage and processing power increasing everyday. Repeated updates are not helping either.

- **Chatbot support by big names:** Thanks to support from companies like Facebook and Microsoft, it is now possible to develop bots for Facebook Messenger, Skype, Slack, Telegram and some other popular messengers.
- **Lower costs:** Chatbots are easier to develop and maintain compared to apps, being almost entirely server side applications. On top of that, the same companies mentioned earlier have made available quite easy to use development tools that utilise their sizeable research into the area.

I'M CONVINCED! I WANT TO WORK WITH CHATBOTS

Hold your horses! We know that impressive investment statements and industry forecasts look quite lucrative – but a better way to decide whether you want to be a part of this industry is to understand which skills are needed for the area. And to do that, you need to know what chatbots are made of.

Like many other consumer facing web-based technologies, chatbots can be divided into a front-end and a back-end. As Swapan Rajdev, Co-Founder and CTO, Haptik Inc. explains, the front-end can be provided by platforms such as Facebook Messenger, Slack, Twitter etc., through standard tools. Additionally, companies like Haptik

WHAT ABOUT VOICE BOTS?

The smart assistant segment has been quite popular because of consumer devices such as Google Home, Amazon Echo and more. Voice-based bots are not too different from chatbots – in fact, they mostly comprise of an additional layer of services and APIs that convert text to speech and vice versa. The key to understanding different accents and speech speed itself is a distinct machine learning problem that deserves its own piece.